

Marketing Manual

Pharmaceutical Manufacturing Plant (Nigeria)

1. Introduction & Purpose

- Define the role of marketing: To promote pharmaceutical products ethically, ensuring compliance with NAFDAC and Nigerian laws.
- Purpose: Support sales growth while protecting public health and maintaining the company's reputation.
- Scope: Covers product branding, advertising, distribution, market research, and promotional activities.

2. Regulatory Framework

- **NAFDAC:** All pharmaceutical adverts and promotions must be approved by NAFDAC.
- **PCN:** Promotion of ethical drugs must involve registered pharmacists.
- **WHO Ethical Criteria for Medicinal Drug Promotion:** Marketing must be factual, accurate, and not misleading.
- **Nigeria Labour & Competition Laws:** Prohibit false claims, unfair competition, and deceptive pricing.

3. Marketing Objectives

- Build trust and reputation for the company's products.
- Increase product awareness among healthcare professionals (HCPs), institutions, and the public.
- Support sales through ethical promotion and strong distribution networks.

4. Marketing Strategies

1. Product Positioning & Branding

- Clear, consistent branding (packaging, trademarks, anti-counterfeit features).
- Educational messaging rather than exaggerated claims.

2. Market Research

- Continuous monitoring of competitors, pricing, and customer needs.
- Feedback collection from hospitals, pharmacies, and distributors.

3. Target Market Segmentation

- Hospitals, clinics, community pharmacies, wholesalers, and government health programs.
- Prioritize essential drugs lists and therapeutic areas in demand (e.g., antibiotics, antimalarials).

4. Promotional Activities

- Approved medical detailing by trained representatives (must be pharmacists or trained staff).
- Educational seminars, workshops, and CMEs (Continuing Medical Education).
- Distribution of approved promotional materials (brochures, samples with proper records).

5. Marketing Compliance & Ethics

- No off-label promotion of products.
- No exaggerated therapeutic claims.
- Promotional materials must include product information, batch details, and approval number.
- Gifts, inducements, or incentives to healthcare professionals must comply with ethical codes.

6. Sales & Distribution Support

- Establish reliable distribution channels to pharmacies, hospitals, and wholesalers.
- Follow **Good Distribution Practices (GDP)** for product storage and transport.

- Monitor sales performance through monthly reports.

7. Digital & Media Marketing

- Digital campaigns must comply with NAFDAC's **online advertising regulations**.
- Only approved adverts should be posted on websites, social media, or online pharmacies.
- No misleading claims — focus on education and awareness.

8. Marketing Team Roles & Responsibilities

- **Head of Marketing:** Develops strategies, ensures compliance, approves campaigns.
- **Medical Representatives:** Promote products ethically to HCPs, collect feedback.
- **Regulatory Affairs Officer:** Ensures NAFDAC approval of promotional materials.
- **Distribution/Logistics Manager:** Oversees delivery of products to market.

9. Monitoring & Evaluation

- Track sales data, market share, and customer satisfaction.
- Regular review of competitor activity and industry trends.
- Annual review of marketing strategy.

10. Annexes

- Annex A: Marketing Approval Request Form.
- Annex B: Promotional Material Approval Checklist.
- Annex C: Monthly Sales & Marketing Report Template.
- Annex D: Sample Medical Representative Visit Log.